

GLOSSARY

Code-mixing: Combining words or phrases from different languages in speech; a natural part of learning a new language.

Code-switching: Alternating between two or more languages depending on the situation or listener; used to aid comprehension and communication.

Home Language / First Language / Mother Tongue (L1): The language a child first acquires, used at home and in daily life; supported in early learning to ease the transition to a second language.

Letter Recognition: Identifying letters by name and understanding their visual features.

Listening Comprehension: Understanding spoken language by processing sounds, words, and meaning in context.

Multilingualism: The ability to understand and use more than one language; recognised as a strength in Indian classrooms.

Oral Language Development: The gradual acquisition of listening and speaking skills through meaningful interactions, forming the foundation for literacy in a second language.

Phonemic Awareness: The ability to hear and manipulate individual sounds in spoken words, essential for reading development.

Reading: The process of interpreting written text to derive meaning; developed through exposure to spoken language, vocabulary, and print.

Second Language (L2): A new language learnt after the home language, often taught in school; introduced through oral experiences and gradual exposure.

Silent Period: A stage in second language learning where learners listen and observe without speaking, while internalising vocabulary and structure.

Sound–Symbol Association: Linking spoken sounds to written letters or letter groups.

Speaking: The ability to use language orally to express thoughts, needs, and ideas; developed through practice, modelling, and meaningful interaction.

Translanguaging: Using two or more languages flexibly to make meaning and learn, allowing learners to switch between languages as needed.

Word Recognition: The ability to identify and read words accurately, including decoding sounds and recognising familiar sight words.

Writing: Expressing thoughts and ideas using written symbols; builds on oral language and reading, starting with simple, meaningful contexts.